

roundtable



Photograph: SHRIYA PATIL. Location courtesy: OUT OF THE BLUE, Mumbai

Let's Talk About Sex

A PSYCHIATRIST, A FORMER VEEJAY, AN ARTIST AND A DESIGNER DUO
TALK ON INFIDELITY, NUPTIAL ANXIETY AND THE THREE-LETTER WORD

Sex is better done than discussed but five brave conversationalists decided to debate the INDIA TODAY AC Nielsen-ORG-MARG survey and its somewhat alarming results on infidelity, forced sex and post-marital anxiety. Forty-eight-year-old psychiatrist Dr Harish Shetty, 36-year-old former veejay Luke Kenny, 33-year-old artist Payal Khandwala, and designer duo, Falguni, 31, and Shane Peacock, 33, got together at a roundtable, literally, and talked about

love, sex, marriage and everything else in between. DEVAYANI SHAHANE listened in.

Q. Will the rise in extra marital relationships be the biggest challenge for most urban relationships?

Dr Harish Shetty (HS): Well the word extra marital is judgmental. Evaluating contemporary behaviour with yesterday's laws is unfair. The fast-growing, developing world uses the home as a sleeping bag and the office cubicle as a garden of courtship. Skin to skin is no sin, it helps to

relax and truly pluralistic relationships are polygamous. Fidelity has many definitions and it is an insult to the human heart when it is divided into categories in a reductionist manner.

Luke Kenny (LK): There is nothing right or wrong about infidelity. But there is this moral and social guilt associated with infidelity within an institution. The bottom line is that human beings are sexual animals.

Payal Khandwala (PK): Infidelity is not the biggest challenge here. The biggest

responsibility instead is balancing work and home, defining new roles for the genders and not succumbing to the temptation of 'what more' in a generation that is plagued with bigger and better.

Q. If your partner philandered, would you be able to forgive and forget?

PK: If it was a pattern then I'd probably walk out, but if it was a one-off thing I might be willing to understand why. I might be more likely to leave if there was physical and mental abuse.